

The A.W.E. System Overview

A.W.E. is a minimalist, narrative-first tabletop system built around three core attributes: **Agility**, **Wit**, and **Endurance**. Characters are intentionally *finished*, not progression-heavy, and mechanical resolution is designed to be rare and meaningful.

Dice are optional. Judgment comes first.

Core Attributes

The three primary attributes are:

- **Agility** – speed, dexterity, reflexes, physical finesse
- **Wit** – intelligence, perception, cleverness, tactical thinking
- **Endurance** – toughness, stamina, pain tolerance, survivability

Each attribute is rated on a **1–10 scale**, grouped into proficiency tiers:

Score	Tier
1–2	Pathetic
3–4	Average
5–6	Adept
7–8	Master
9–10	Inhuman

The **tier** matters more than the number.

Using Attributes (Without Dice)

A.W.E. assumes that most actions do **not** require rolling dice.

The Game Master adjudicates outcomes based on tier alone:

- **Pathetic:** Cannot reasonably succeed
- **Average:** Possible, but uncertain
- **Adept:** Reliable success
- **Master:** Exceptional success
- **Inhuman:** Beyond normal human limits

Example (Agility):

- Pathetic: Cannot scale a 6-foot wall
- Average: Might scale it with a roll
- Adept: Scales it automatically
- Master: Scales it and leaps to a nearby rooftop without rolling

If success is obvious for someone of that tier, **no roll is required**.

Dice and Opposed Checks

Dice are only used when **two characters are directly opposed** or when outcomes are meaningfully uncertain *between equals*.

Dice Pool

- Number of dice = **Attribute ÷ 2 (rounded down)**

Example:

- Agility 3–4 → 1 die
- Agility 5–6 → 2 dice

Although moving from an odd number to an even number grants an extra die, **tiers remain more important than dice**. An Adept will always outperform an Average character unless circumstances strongly favor the weaker party.

Dice exist to *resolve conflict*, not define capability.

Endurance and Wounds

Endurance governs both resilience and survival.

Tolerance

Tolerance equals the number of Endurance dice a character has and represents how many **Major Wounds** they can sustain before being incapacitated.

A **Major Wound** is something severe (roughly equivalent to a knife wound to the torso).

Examples:

- **Endurance 4:** Can take a knife wound and continue fighting
- **Endurance 2:** Knife wound drops them, but does not kill them
- **Endurance 1:** Knife wound is immediately fatal

Minor harm (punches, scrapes, exhaustion) does not count as a Major Wound.

Push

Push is a flexible, character-defined resource.

Push has **no universal function**. Instead, each character's Push represents how they exceed their limits or bend reality.

Common Uses

Most Game Masters allow Push to:

- Reroll a check (once per roll)
- Negate a Major Wound

Character-Specific Uses

Push is defined collaboratively between player and GM.

Examples:

- A wizard spends Push to cast powerful or spectacular magic
- A duelist spends Push to add Wit dice to Agility checks while fencing
- A shapeshifter spends Push to unleash a temporary beast form
- A fragile noble spends Push to have their superhuman bodyguard intervene

Push expresses **who the character is**, not what the system allows.

Character Creation

A.W.E. characters are built to feel complete from the start. Stat growth is rare, and characters are not expected to scale toward inhuman levels unless justified by the narrative.

Vanilla Start

- **10 points** to distribute among Agility, Wit, and Endurance
- **2 Push**
- Push usage must be discussed with the GM

Alternate Start (“Push Start”)

- **6 points** to distribute among attributes
- **4 Push**
- Often represents indirect power, protection, or narrative leverage

This option favors characters whose strength comes from *external forces* rather than personal capability.